



## Questions for Open Evenings and Open Days

Five mornings of registration before an open evening or a university open day, each one a different kind of question to ask when you get there: the course, the day or the teaching, the people, the money, and what happens if it goes wrong. Two sets of slides, one for Year 10 and 11 and one for Year 12 and 13, and a sheet for each.

**Before you start.** Not every student will be going to an open evening or an open day, and for some the question of what comes next is a difficult one at home. The activity is about asking, not about where anybody is going, and nobody is asked to say which evenings they are attending.

### Print these

| Pages         | What it is                                                                          |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pages 2 and 3 | The open evening sheet for Year 10 and 11, one per student, double-sided if you can |
| Pages 4 and 5 | The open day sheet for sixth form, one per student, double-sided if you can         |

### The five mornings

| Morning   | What happens                                                                                                                                               | Slide |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Monday    | Hand out the sheet for your year. Three questions about the course, then the form adds its own: two or three go on the board and onto the sheet.           | 2     |
| Tuesday   | The day, for Year 10 and 11: hours, free periods, start and finish. The teaching, for sixth form: who teaches, and what week three looks like. Same shape. | 3     |
| Wednesday | The people: who to go to, class or seminar sizes, whether people settle. Same shape.                                                                       | 4     |
| Thursday  | Money, and getting there or living there: costs, bursaries, the journey or the accommodation. Same shape.                                                  | 5     |
| Friday    | If it goes wrong: changing course, missed grades, what support there is. Then the sheet goes in the bag.                                                   | 6     |
| After     | The Monday after the open evening or open day: which question got the most useful answer, and which one nobody answered.                                   | 7     |

### Worth knowing

- The form's own questions are usually better than the printed ones. Leave time for them.
- Run it in any week before the open evenings or open days start. Some schools put the first ones in late September, and university open days run from June to October.
- A student who is not going anywhere still asks the questions of the school they are in. The sixth form set is written for a university open day; for an apprenticeship or a college, cross out what does not fit.

**New resources go up on [thepastoralguide.com](http://thepastoralguide.com) as they are made. Leave your email there and you will hear when they do.**





# Questions to ask

For a sixth form or college open evening. Tick a question when it has been answered, and write the answer under it. There is a line in each section for one of your own.

## About the course

☐

How is it assessed: exams, coursework, or both?

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☐

What did last year's students go on to do?

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☐

What does a normal week of this course look like?

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☐

One of your own:

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## About the day

☐

How many hours a week am I in lessons, and what happens in the gaps?

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☐

Where do students go when they have a free period?

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☐

What time does the day start and finish?

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☐

One of your own:

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## About the people

☐

Who would I go to if I was struggling?

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☐

How many people are usually in a class?

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☐

Do students who did not come from this school settle in?

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☐

One of your own:

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## Questions to ask

*The last two kinds of question, and space at the bottom for anything you noticed that nobody told you.*

### About money and getting there

☐

Is there any cost for trips, books or equipment?

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☐

Is there a bursary or any help with costs, and how do I apply?

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☐

How do most students get here in the morning?

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☐

One of your own:

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### If it goes wrong

☐

What happens if I pick the wrong subject in the first term?

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☐

Can I change courses, and until when?

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☐

What support is there if my grades are not what I hoped?

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☐

One of your own:

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### Something I noticed that nobody told me

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# Questions to ask

For a university open day. Tick a question when it has been answered, and write the answer under it. There is a line in each section for one of your own.

## About the course

☐

How is it assessed, and how much of that is exams?

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☐

How many contact hours a week, and how much of that is small groups rather than lectures?

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☐

What did the students who finished last year go on to do?

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☐

One of your own:

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## About the teaching

☐

Who teaches first years: lecturers, or postgraduate students?

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☐

How much of the week is timetabled, and what am I expected to do with the rest?

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☐

What would I actually be doing in week three of the first term?

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☐

One of your own:

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## About the people

☐

Who do I go to if I am struggling, with the work or with anything else?

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☐

How many people are on the course, and how many in a seminar?

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☐

What do students do here who are not into the nightlife?

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☐

One of your own:

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## Questions to ask

*The last two kinds of question, and space at the bottom for anything you noticed that nobody told you.*

### About money and living

☐

What does accommodation cost, and is a place guaranteed in the first year?

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☐

What bursaries or scholarships are there, and how do I apply?

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☐

Do students work part-time alongside the course, and does it fit?

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☐

One of your own:

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### If it goes wrong

☐

Can I change course, and until when?

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☐

What happens if I miss the grades in my offer?

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☐

If I am not happy by Christmas, what are my options?

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☐

One of your own:

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### Something I noticed that nobody told me

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